final. Coaches and chief executives wonder what you have done for them lately. Sometimes we all forget we are in a people business. We are dealing with sensitive individuals whose feelings are occasionally compromised by their faults, or their familiarity.

One of my enduring regrets is the way I handled my role in the decision to part company with Graham Gooch as England's batting coach after the Ashes whitewash in Australia in 2014. We were dealing with a legend of the game, a good man. Without his dedication and selflessness, I would never have become the player I did.

The logic, that we needed to wipe the slate clean after the departure of Andy Flower and the bitterness of Kevin Pietersen's exit, was cold but understandable. The thought processes involved were pretty straightforward. It was an easy decision. When you get blown away so badly, someone has to take the rap.

Goochy was so close to Andy that I didn't think we could move forward with the same messages being delivered. We needed a fresh start, the momentum of new personnel. I should have refused when Peter Moores, the new head coach, asked me to communicate our decision. We were, after all, rationalizing his support staff. I had no influence in Peter's appointment, but a cricket captain's job description includes the passing on of bad news.

Not only should I probably not have been given the responsibility of doing so in this instance, but also the manner in which I did so was wrong. I should have just climbed into the car and informed him face-to-face. I owed him that. I rang him three times to arrange a meeting, but we kept missing one another, and eventually I told him over the phone. He knew what was coming. 'Just tell me,' he said. It was distant and impersonal, unworthy.

This was different from our mutually agreed decision to scale back my personal coaching sessions with him. Goochy had implanted that idea in my brain by asking whether, after ten years working closely together, I needed to listen to another voice. I went to work with Gary Palmer, whose input was purely technical, in the way a swing coach informs a golfer.

But, with England, I blame myself. Faced with the same decision today, I would have done it differently. There was an understandable distance between us for a couple of years, but Goochy is not one to hold grudges and our relationship has repaired. Scars heal, but we should never forget the pain we can inflict, knowingly or unknowingly.

People like him deserve better.